

The Boston Globe

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Weighing Boston's World Cup turn

High marks for fans, trains; but not a perfect run

By Chris Serres,
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For 27 days and nights, life in Boston revolved around a spinning ball.

The World Cup transformed the city into a vibrant, global carnival. Leading the charge was a tidal wave of Scottish fans — the legendary “Tartan Army”— who took over Boston’s streets, bars, and even Fenway Park.

They were joined by boisterous crowds representing Morocco, Haiti, Ghana, Germany, France, England, Iraq, and Norway. By day, Boston was a shifting sea of color; by night, the air buzzed with revelry as the city’s nightlife and dating scene came alive like never before.

The spectacle on the streets was matched by the drama on the pitch. There were sold-out crowds for seven games and a historic tournament was executed without a significant logistical glitch.

Did the tournament live up to its massive promise? What did Boston get right, and where did it stumble?

What worked

The “**Scottish invasion**”: No one expected the biggest showstoppers in Boston to arrive in kilts.

WORLD CUP, Page A10



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE
Crowds of more than 63,000 attended each of the seven matches in Foxborough.

The Trump administration has forced out the three remaining members of an independent, bipartisan commission that supports states in administering their elections. **A2.**

Advocates and residents say the death of cyclist Louisa Gag, a transportation planner for Boston, is a tragic example of why they want City Hall to act quickly to fix dangerous streets across the city. **B1.**

Brigham and Women's Hospital issued a cease-and-desist letter to striking nurses over “excessive noise.” **D1.**



Pair of aces

Saturday: Warm, drier. High: 77-82. Low: 64-69.
Sunday: Sunny, nice. High: 76-81. Low: 63-68.
Sunrise: 5:17 Sunset: 8:22
Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

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ABOARD A BIT OF HISTORY

On a Romanian tall ship, the work is hard, the quarters tight, and the views amazing



Story by Brian MacQuarrie
Photos by Stan Grossfeld
GLOBE STAFF

ABOARD THE N.S. MIRCEA — The wind finally had freshened to a sail-swelling 17 m.p.h. Thursday when a Romanian training officer pumped his fists, paced the deck, and exhorted dozens of naval cadets in a sharp, staccato voice to do what doesn’t come naturally to most people.

Climb high into the rigging of a tall ship. Shuffle along a spar more than 100 feet above deck and untie a furled sail. Do all this while rolling on the open ocean and standing only on a thin cable. But don’t worry, there’s a buckle for the spar.

“Be strong!” urged Stefan Scutelnicu, the Mircea’s senior sail-training officer.

“Hoo-rah! Hoo-rah! Hoo-rah!” the young cadets shouted before applauding and clambering aloft to masts that rise 144 feet over the scrubbed wooden deck.

And strong they were, climbing and working with a purposeful, fearless precision that smacked of age-old sailing choreography.

Dropping the Mircea’s sails was the pulsating prelude to a long race that began later Thursday among four “sister ships” that are headed to Boston for the tall ships celebration beginning Saturday.

The crew of the three-masted Mircea, the Black Sea-based training vessel of the Romanian Naval Academy, eagerly awaited the sprint north along Cape Cod from far

SHIP, Page A10



Top: The German tall ship Gorch Fock, seen from the dentist office on the Mircea, headed to the starting line for the Four Sisters Race. Above: Midshipman Ilie Iftode pulled in the lines aboard the Mircea during its departure from New York.

After violent weekend, local leaders seek solutions, urge against despair

By Lea Skene
GLOBE STAFF

They came from a generation of Black men who lived through rampant gun violence, lost themselves in the streets of Boston, and came out the other side.

But this was an unfamiliar grief. This time, they were mourning a son.

Christopher Washington-Conway, 29, was killed early Sunday when gunfire shattered a large block party in Roxbury.

All the hard-earned wisdom of his elders wasn’t enough to save him. Neither was his own hard work and ambition. He had a college degree, a well-paying job, and a legion of supporters rooting for his continued success.

Despite decades of progress placing Boston among the safest major cities in the country, a violent Fourth of July weekend reopened old wounds. Two young men died and 11 other people were injured in five separate shootings, prompting immediate outcry from elected officials and community leaders alike. The holiday served as a painful reminder that gun violence remains a devastating force, its impacts heavily concentrated in historically underserved communities.

“When you look around, you’ll

‘We can’t allow these losses to take the fuel and allow us to self-destruct.’

STANLEY GREENE, longtime friend of victim’s father



Mark “Scoop” Adams led a prayer at a vigil on Wednesday, mourning the death of Christopher Washington-Conway.

see soldiers that have done a lot of time, that have a lot of experience. And we’re the ones we need to turn to in these times,” said Stanley Greene, a longtime friend of Washington-Conway’s father who addressed a crowd of mourners

Wednesday night in Dorchester’s Grove Hall neighborhood.

“We can’t allow these losses to take the fuel and allow us to self-destruct,” he said. “When we talk about breaking generational curses, this is

VICTIM, Page A6

McDreamy for Senate wasn’t hard to imagine

Pop culture’s place in politics is secure

By Chris Vognar
GLOBE STAFF

As Graham Platner bowed out of the Maine senatorial race amid further scandal, this time a sexual assault accusation, various names were floated as his replacement.

CRITIC’S NOTEBOOK

Some of the ideas seemed natural enough, like the progressive former state senator Troy Jackson, who finished third in the Democratic primary for governor in June. There was also preliminary buzz around Boston College history professor and prolific Substacker Heather Cox Richardson.

But the name that really got tongues wagging was favorite Maine son Patrick Dempsey, the actor best known for playing Dr. Derek “McDreamy” Shepherd on “Grey’s Anatomy.” The star of a steamy nighttime soap opera? As a US senator from the Pine Tree State? There was a time when the very notion would have seemed absurd.

But that time has passed, along with so many other political norms.

DEMPSEY, Page A7